

Ashcombe Advisory Partners LLC

www.ashcombeadvisory.com

February 5, 2017

Mary Frank
Director of Operations
Barrera Group

Dear Ms. Frank:

This letter confirms that Barrera Group has engaged this firm to lead its corporate positioning work. It sets out what we will do, who will do it, what it costs, and the terms we both agree to. If anything here does not match the conversation we had, say so before you sign rather than after. Positioning only holds when both sides are describing the same company, and this letter is the first place we get to confirm that we are.

Scope of the Engagement

The engagement is a single body of work: a clear, defensible position for Barrera Group in front of the audiences that matter to it, and the language to carry that position through the announcements and conversations ahead. We are not there to change how your company is run. We are there to make sure that what is already true about it is understood by the people whose understanding counts, and that it is said the same way twice.

Our approach is plain and we have used it for years. We begin by listening: to you, to the people inside your organization who own the story, and to the outside audiences who already hold a version of it that we may need to correct. From there we agree a small number of core messages in writing, because a position that lives only in conversation drifts the moment three people repeat it. We then build the materials that carry those messages, and we stay close through the moments that test them. We would rather say less and have it hold than say more and spend the following year walking it back.

The Team

Daniel Valenzuela will lead the engagement day to day and is your point of contact for anything of substance. He deliberately runs a small number of relationships at once, so that the one in front of him has his attention, and he is the person who turns

a worry you raise on a Friday into a concrete step by Monday. When you need a decision moved, go to him first.

Michelle Rose will assemble the messaging and the drafts and keep the moving parts legible as they multiply. She writes a dense update in a way you can actually read, and she would rather raise a small question early than let it grow into a large one late. Between the two of them, you will always know what has changed and what is still open.

I lead this firm and I read the work that leaves it. I will not sit on your calls week to week, but I am reachable directly, and if the engagement is not going the way you expected I would far rather hear it from you than read it later. Call me, and do not be polite about it.

Fees and Payment

Our fee for this engagement is \$59,000, fixed at the outset and quoted as a single figure rather than as a rate against hours. We work to a fixed fee because it keeps our attention on the outcome instead of the clock, and because you should be able to call us with a question without watching a meter run. The fee is billed in two equal installments, the first on commencement and the second at the midpoint of the term. Reasonable out-of-pocket costs that you approve in advance, such as travel to meet your stakeholders or the production of finished materials, are billed at cost and itemized on each invoice. Invoices are payable within thirty days of receipt.

Term and Termination

The engagement commences on February 15, 2017 and runs approximately five months, which is the basis on which we have planned the work. Either of us may end it on fifteen days' written notice. If you end it, you owe the installments that have fallen due as of that date and the approved costs incurred to it, and nothing further. If we end it, which we would do only if the work as agreed had become work we could not do honestly, we will return any fee already paid for work not yet performed.

Confidentiality

Discretion is central to this kind of work. We will treat your internal information, your plans, and the fact and content of this engagement as confidential, and we will use anything you tell us about Barrera Group that is not already public only to do the work you have retained us for, sharing it no further than the people on both sides who need it. We ask the same of you regarding our methods and our materials. Where an announcement or a disclosure carries its own timing, we follow yours and not our own convenience.

Limitation of Liability

We will carry out this engagement with the care and skill customary in our profession. We do not control how an audience receives a message or how a market moves on a given day, and we do not warrant a particular result, because the parts that decide it are not ours to command. Our total liability under this engagement, on any theory, is limited to the fees actually paid to us for it, and neither of us is liable to the other for indirect or consequential loss. Nothing in this paragraph limits liability for fraud or willful misconduct, and nothing should.

Governing Law

This letter is the entire agreement between us on this engagement and replaces anything said or drafted before it. It is governed by the law of the state in which this firm keeps its principal office, and any dispute we cannot settle between ourselves goes to the courts sitting in that state, to whose jurisdiction we each consent. Amendments take effect only in writing signed by both of us.

Acceptance

If this letter reflects our agreement, please sign below and return one copy to me. Daniel Valenzuela will be in touch within the week to set the kickoff and to agree the first pieces of work. I am glad Barrera Group chose us for this. It is a good piece of work and a winnable one, and we intend to earn the choice.

Very truly yours,

Julie Hill

Managing Partner

Date: February 5, 2017

Mary Frank

Director of Operations, Barrera Group

Date: February 5, 2017